

OS Installation and Recovery -- Guided Notes ANSWER KEY

Unit 3.3 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. Core 2 1.3 | N10-008

For instructor use / distribute after students complete the notes.

Question 1

A _____ install completely wipes the existing drive and installs a fresh copy of Windows, removing all user data and applications. An _____ install preserves the user's files, settings, and installed applications while replacing the OS files. An upgrade is only available from a _____ (older/newer) version of Windows.

Answer: Clean; upgrade (in-place upgrade); supported older.

Question 2

_____ is a free tool used to create a bootable USB drive from a Windows ISO file. After downloading the Windows ISO from Microsoft, you point Rufus to the _____ file, select the USB drive, choose the _____ partition scheme (required for UEFI + Windows 11), and click Start.

Answer: Rufus; ISO; GPT.

Question 3

To boot from a USB drive, the technician must change the _____ order in UEFI settings so the USB device is listed _____ the hard drive. UEFI settings are accessed by pressing a key such as _____, _____, or _____ immediately when the system powers on (varies by manufacturer).

Answer: Boot; before (above); Del, F2, or F12 (common keys).

Question 4

Windows 11 requires UEFI boot with _____ disabled (no legacy CSM mode) and a _____ partition table on the drive. It also requires _____ version 2.0 and _____ (a firmware security feature). These requirements exist to improve _____ compared to older Windows versions.

Answer: CSM (legacy mode); GPT; TPM; Secure Boot; security.

Question 5

Windows Recovery Environment (WinRE) provides repair tools when Windows fails to start. It can be accessed by pressing _____ + Restart in Windows Settings, holding _____ while clicking Restart, or by Windows automatically offering it after _____ consecutive failed boot attempts.

Answer: Shift (Start > Power, hold Shift, click Restart); Shift; two (2) or three (3).

Question 6

System Restore returns the OS to a previous _____ point, undoing recent driver or software changes, while preserving _____. Reset This PC re-installs Windows and gives the user the option to _____ or _____ personal files. Reset This PC is more thorough and is closer to a _____ install.

Answer: Restore point; personal files (documents and data); keep; remove; clean.

Question 7

After a clean Windows installation, the recommended driver installation order is: _____ drivers first, then _____ drivers, then GPU drivers, then peripheral drivers. The chipset drivers must go first because they enable the CPU, PCIe lanes, and USB controllers that _____ drivers depend on.

Answer: Chipset; motherboard (audio, LAN, etc.); other.

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A customer brings in a laptop running Windows 10 with a failed SSD. You replace the SSD with a new NVMe drive and attempt a clean Windows 11 install from USB. The installer says the PC does not meet the requirements. List the most likely causes in order of probability and describe the UEFI settings you would check to resolve each one.

Answer: Most likely causes in order: 1) TPM 2.0 is disabled in UEFI -- check Security settings for TPM/fTPM and enable it. 2) Secure Boot is disabled -- check Boot settings and enable Secure Boot (also requires CSM to be off). 3) CSM (Legacy mode) is enabled -- disable CSM/legacy mode so UEFI-only mode is active; required for GPT and Secure Boot. 4) Drive is MBR-formatted -- new NVMe should default to GPT, but verify the installer uses GPT partitioning. 5) CPU does not meet Windows 11 requirements (check Microsoft compatibility list -- minimum 8th Gen Intel or Ryzen 2000). Resolution: enable TPM, enable Secure Boot, disable CSM, confirm GPT partition scheme in installer.